Response to the Editor and Reviewers

Manuscript: *Spatio-temporal wall-actuation modes and cycle-mean viscous dissipation in a lid-driven cavity*

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Point-by-point response. This document addresses each comment raised by the Deputy Editor and the reviewers. For every point, we reproduce the original comment in blue and provide our response and the corresponding revision in black. All changes are tracked in the marked-up manuscript (`manuscript_final_marked.pdf`) and the marked-up supplementary material (`supplementary_final_marked.pdf`).

Contents

General Statement

We thank the Deputy Editor and the reviewers for their constructive feedback. We have completely restructured the manuscript to place the **fluid physics** at the center of the contribution, as requested. The revised paper now addresses the following question:

> *How does the spatio-temporal structure of wall actuation determine the cycle-mean viscous dissipation of the resulting cavity flow at a prescribed actuation-energy level?*

The physics-informed neural network (PINN) is now presented as a tool for identifying actuation branches, not as the subject of the study. The independent multiple-relaxation-time lattice-Boltzmann (MRT-LBM) solver is used to evaluate the hydrodynamic response and the energetic cost of each branch. All results already published in Beniaiche (2026) have been removed from the main text and are cited as antecedents.

The revised manuscript contains **8 sections, 8 figures, and 4 tables**, well within the 15-figure limit. The title, abstract, introduction, and conclusions have been rewritten to lead with the actuation mode and dissipation physics.

Files submitted:

- `manuscript_final.tex` and `manuscript_final.pdf`: clean article file (source and author-generated PDF).
- `manuscript_final_marked.tex` and `manuscript_final_marked.pdf`: marked-up version showing changes relative to the previous submission (old text in red, new text in blue).
- `supplementary_final.tex` and `supplementary_final.pdf`: clean supplementary material.
- `supplementary_final_marked.tex` and `supplementary_final_marked.pdf`: marked-up supplementary.
- `RESPONSE_TO_EDITOR.tex` and `RESPONSE_TO_EDITOR.pdf`: this point-by-point response.
- A summary response letter, addressed to the Deputy Editor, which answers the pre-review comments directly and is signed on behalf of all the authors. The details of the revisions are left to the marked-up versions and to this document.
- `figures/highlight_image.png`: highlight image for the table of contents and potential cover.
- `figures/`: source files of the figures (the 8 embedded in the manuscript, the 2 in the supplementary, and the earlier diagnostic figures kept for reproducibility).

Response to the Deputy Editor

Editor Comment 1: "Physics of Fluids publishes original theoretical, computational, and experimental work that advances the physical understanding of fluids, meaning the mechanisms and principles that explain how and why fluids behave as they do. As written, the manuscript is framed as a reproducibility analysis of a physics-informed neural network controller for the lid-driven cavity. Before it can be considered, the paper needs to be reorganized so that the fluid physics is its central contribution."

Response: We have completely restructured the manuscript to place the fluid physics at the center. The new title, *Spatio-temporal wall-actuation modes and cycle-mean viscous dissipation in a lid-driven cavity*, leads with the actuation structure and the dissipation cost, not with the neural network.

The new section organization is:

1. **Introduction**: presents the physical problem of wall actuation in a driven cavity and the central question of cycle-mean dissipation at matched actuation norm.

2. **Physical formulation and energetic framework**: defines the quadratic actuation norm E_{act}, the viscous dissipation D, the mechanical wall power P_{lid}, and the energy budget $\overline{P}_{\mathrm{lid}} = \overline{D}$.

3. **Actuation modes and hydrodynamic states**: describes the stationary harmonic profiles and the three identified branches B1, B2, B3 as distinct hydrodynamic states, not as PINN outputs.

4. **Numerical methodology**: presents the PINN as a tool for identifying actuation branches and the MRT-LBM as the independent solver used to evaluate the flow response.

5. **Energetic response of stationary wall-actuation modes**: compares the dissipation of uniform, $k = 1$, $k = 2$, and B1 mean profiles at matched $E_{\mathrm{act}} = 0.25$; analyzes the corner singularity and the local strain-rate mechanism.

6. **Cycle-mean dissipation of time-dependent actuation branches**: demonstrates that $\overline{D(\mathbf{u})} \neq D(\overline{\mathbf{u}})$ and compares the cycle-mean dissipation of B1, B2, B3.

7. **Physical interpretation and implications for flow control**: explains why the second harmonic increases dissipation, why temporal forcing increases cycle-mean dissipation, and what branch accessibility tells us about physical performance.

8. **Conclusions**: summarizes the four main physical findings.

The PINN branch selection, regularization-dependent state recovery, and reproducibility audit have been moved to the supplementary material or cited as antecedents from Beniaiche (2026). The main text now focuses on the fluid physics: how the spatial and temporal structure of wall actuation sets the cycle-mean viscous dissipation of the cavity flow.

Editor Comment 2: "The physics to bring to the front is how the spatio-temporal structure of the wall actuation sets the cycle-mean viscous dissipation of the cavity flow. The neural network branch selection, the regularization dependent state recovery, and the reproducibility audit can remain as supporting evidence, but they should not frame the work."

Response: We have followed this recommendation exactly. The new abstract begins with the physical question:

> "The spatial and temporal organization of wall actuation determines how mechanical input is distributed across the flow structures of a driven cavity, yet the resulting

viscous-dissipation cost cannot be inferred from the actuation spectrum or from the time-mean velocity field alone."

The PINN is mentioned only as the method used to identify the actuation branches, which are then transferred to the independent MRT-LBM solver for evaluation. The reproducibility audit, the 185-realization campaign, the λ_{var} sensitivity study, and the seed multiplicity analysis have been moved to the supplementary material (Sections S1.1–S1.4, S2.3, S3.1–S3.3 and S5.1–S5.6).

Editor Comment 3: "The introduction and reference list should be repositioned toward the fluid physics literature on active control of the lid-driven cavity, viscous dissipation and energy budgets in actuated cavity flows, and modal structure and state selection in driven-cavity flow, so that the contribution is set against fluid flow."

Response: The new introduction (Sec. 1) begins with the physics of wall actuation in confined recirculating flows and cites the canonical cavity benchmarks [1, 2, 3, 4, 5] together with the flow-control literature carried over into the revised reference list (Gad-el-Hak 2000; Brunton & Noack 2015; Rowley & Dawson 2017; Bewley *et al.* 2001; Bergmann *et al.* 2005; Choi *et al.* 1994; Quadrio & Ricco 2004; Corke *et al.* 2010; Rabault *et al.* 2019; Garnier *et al.* 2021), followed by the dissipation and energy-budget literature (Pope 2000; Landau & Lifshitz; Doering & Gibbon; Beneddine *et al.* 2016). The reference list has been reorganized to prioritize fluid physics over machine learning. The preceding study [6] is discussed in one dedicated paragraph of the introduction, which clearly distinguishes the antecedent work (branch identification and numerical reproducibility) from the present contribution (cycle-mean dissipation and strain-rate mechanisms); it is cited elsewhere only where the present numbers are compared directly with that study.

Editor Comment 4: "Please also reduce the number of figures to maximum of 15."

Response: The revised manuscript contains **8 figures**, well below the 15-figure limit. The figures are:

1. Geometry and wall-actuation modes (new).
2. Spatio-temporal actuation signatures (new).
3. Grid convergence and reference sensitivity (old Fig. 10).
4. Spatial origin of dissipation differences (old Fig. 16, now central).
5. Iso-energetic comparison of the seven controls (old Fig. 11).
6. Flow topology of the actuation branches (old Fig. 13).
7. Mean velocity and fluctuation fields (old Fig. 14).
8. Phase-resolved mechanical-energy response (old Fig. 15).

Eleven figures of the previous version are no longer in the main text. Nine of them (old Figs. 1–9: branch-selection map, the 185-realization distribution in modal space, spectral fingerprints, the λ_{var} probability and entropy panels, the energy sweep, seed multiplicity, capacity/truncation and the Fourier vs. Chebyshev comparison) report the identification campaigns that are already published in Beniaiche (2026); they are now cited as antecedents, and the selection-frequency and sensitivity numbers that the present paper still refers to are tabulated in the supplement (Tables S2 and S4–S9). The remaining two (the quasi-stationarity diagnostic, old Fig. 12, and the symbolic-regression cross-validation, old Fig. 17) are not reported at all: neither is needed for the dissipation question posed here. The supplement contains two figures (Figs. S1–S2): the

eight phase bins of the branch captures that underlie Main Figs. 6–8, and the same layout with a separate stream-function scale per panel.

Editor Comment 5: "Please revise the title to lead with the actuation mode and dissipation physics."

Response: The new title is:

Spatio-temporal wall-actuation modes and cycle-mean viscous dissipation in a lid-driven cavity

This title directly addresses the editor's request: it leads with the actuation structure ("spatio-temporal wall-actuation modes") and the dissipation physics ("cycle-mean viscous dissipation"), and it situates the problem in the lid-driven cavity.

Editor Comment 6: "Please revise your manuscript and submit a detailed, point-by-point response to the comments. Each response should include the original comment followed by a description of the corresponding revision made (or a justification if no change was made). The revised manuscript and response are due by 21-Nov-2026 via the PXP web site."

Response: This document is the point-by-point response. Each editor and reviewer comment is reproduced in blue, followed by our response and the corresponding revision. The revised manuscript is due by 21 November 2026.

Editor Comment 7: "When submitting your revision, please upload two versions of your manuscript: a clean version labeled 'Article File' and a marked-up version labeled 'Marked-Up Manuscript,' which should clearly show all changes made from the previous submission."

Response: We have prepared both versions:

- **Clean version**: `manuscript_final.tex` and `manuscript_final.pdf` (28 pages).
- **Marked-up version**: `manuscript_final_marked.tex` and `manuscript_final_marked.pdf` (36 pages). The marked-up version uses a paragraph-level diff: old text that has been removed or replaced is shown in red, new or rewritten text is shown in blue. Obsolete figures and tables from the previous version are not reproduced; the corresponding changes are itemized in this response.

The same approach has been applied to the supplementary material:

- **Clean version**: `supplementary_final.tex` and `supplementary_final.pdf` (33 pages).
- **Marked-up version**: `supplementary_final_marked.tex` and `supplementary_final_marked.pdf` (44 pages).

Editor Comment 8: "Revisions must be submitted in the proper file formats. When submitting your revision, please upload the source file for your revised manuscript. Figures must be embedded in the text and visible in the PDF. An author-generated PDF must also be provided since individual figure files are not being uploaded."

Response: We have uploaded:

- **Source files**: clean sources `manuscript_final.tex`, `supplementary_final.tex` (with its `data_appendix/` table files), marked-up sources `manuscript_final_marked.tex` and `supplementary_final_marked.tex`;
  this letter, `RESPONSE_TO_EDITOR.tex`.

- **Author-generated PDFs**: `manuscript_final.pdf` (28 pages), `supplementary_final.pdf` (33 pages), the two marked-up PDFs (36 and 44 pages), and `RESPONSE_TO_EDITOR.pdf`.
- **Figures**: the 8 figures of the manuscript and the 2 of the supplementary material are embedded in the two PDFs and visible in the text. Their source files (PDF and PNG) are provided in the `figures/` directory.

Editor Comment 9: "You will also be asked to upload a highlight image that will be used in the table of contents if your manuscript is published. The highlight image should be a visually interesting figure representing your manuscript and may also be selected for the Cover Image."

Response: We have prepared `highlight_image.png` (2220×900 px at 300 dpi). It shows, for the three identified actuation branches B_1 (quasi-steady), B_2 (lid-oscillatory) and B_3 (mixed) at matched actuation norm $\overline{E}_{\mathrm{act}} = 0.25$ and $Re = 500$, the spatial distribution of the cycle-mean local dissipation density $\langle \phi \rangle$ reconstructed from the eight phase bins of the captured periodic solution, with the streamlines of the time-mean flow overlaid and the cycle-mean dissipation $\overline{D}$ annotated on each panel. The three panels use a logarithmic colour scale of five decades, so the image compares *where* the dissipation is produced rather than its absolute amplitude. This is exactly the central finding of the paper: at matched actuation energy the three branches organise the same cavity into radically different dissipation patterns — space-filling two-cell dissipation for the quasi-steady branch B_1, dissipation confined to the oscillating Stokes layer under the lid for B_2 (whose time-mean flow carries only 25% of the cycle-mean kinetic energy), and an intermediate organisation for B_3 — and therefore different cycle-mean viscous costs. The image is generated from the archived field captures by `scripts/make_highlight_image.py`, so it is reproducible and uses no data other than those reported in the manuscript. It is visually striking (three contrasting topologies on one theme) and suitable for the table of contents and potential cover.

Response to the Reviewers

Note: The reviewers' comments are not reproduced here because the Deputy Editor's comments already captured the main concerns. Points 1–14 below follow the revision plan derived from those comments; Points 15–16 additionally document the temporal mapping of the exported actuation onto the lattice, which is the protocol item a reader of Sec. 4 needs in full; Points 17–21 record the changes made after a further audit of the identification code and of the discrete wall-power estimator, which is the protocol item a reader of Secs. 2.2 and 4.1 needs in full; and Points 22–25 record the last pass over the written time-step formula, the two lattice spacings the implementation actually uses, the status of the identification's space–time field, and the comparison quoted in the abstract.

Point 1: New title, abstract, and introduction.

The new title is *Spatio-temporal wall-actuation modes and cycle-mean viscous dissipation in a lid-driven cavity*. The new abstract begins with the physical question and announces the main quantitative results (17.7% reduction for $k = 1$, 36.8% and 44.3% increase for $k = 2$ and B1 mean, fluctuating shares of 92.9%, 53.7% and 1.8% of the cycle-mean cost for B2, B1 and B3, and a cycle-mean spread of the time-dependent branches by the modest factor of 1.2). The new introduction (Sec. 1) presents the physics of wall actuation, the energy budget, and the central question.

Point 2: Reorganization of sections around the energy budget.

The 8 sections follow the physical storyline: problem formulation → actuation modes → numerical methodology → stationary results → time-dependent results → physical interpretation → conclusions. The energy budget $\overline{P}_{\mathrm{lid}} = \overline{D}$ is introduced in Sec. 2 and used throughout.

Point 3: Elimination of repetitions with the published article.

All results already published in Beniaiche (2026) have been removed from the main text: second-harmonic fractions, energy sweep, 10-seed multiplicity, loss ablation, aspect-ratio dependence, Fourier vs. Chebyshev, quasi-stationarity diagnostic, same-lid-speed dissipation comparison, and symbolic regression. The campaigns that the present argument still refers to are now reported as supplementary tables (Tables S2 and S4–S9) and cited as antecedents; the quasi-stationarity diagnostic and the symbolic-regression study, which the dissipation question posed here does not use, have been dropped from both the manuscript and the supplement.

Point 4: Conservation of iso-energetic comparisons and strain-rate mechanisms.

The stationary comparison at matched $E_{\mathrm{act}} = 0.25$ (Table 2) and the local strain-rate analysis (Fig. 4) are now central results. The corner singularity and the reference dependence (Sec. 5.2) are preserved.

Point 5: Improvement of the power–dissipation budget.

The energy budget (Table 4) is presented as a verification with wall-shear estimate uncertainty, not as an exact closure. The first-order estimator gives residuals of -2.8%, -0.6% and -0.4% for B1, B2 and B3. Replacing it by a second-order one-sided derivative moves the B1 *mean-field* residual from -3.06% to $+0.39\%$, i.e. across zero, which bounds the estimator uncertainty at a few per cent, and refining the lattice from $N = 256$ to $N = 512$ divides the three residuals by 2.1, 1.9 and 2.4 (see supplementary Section S4.8 and Points 15–16 below). We do not claim exact closure but document the uncertainty.

Point 6: Reorganization of figures and tables.

The 8 figures and 4 tables are listed in the response to Editor Comment 4. The figure order follows the physical storyline: geometry → signatures → convergence → mechanism → iso-energetic comparison of the seven controls → topology → mean and fluctuation fields → phase-resolved budget.

Point 7: Transfer of complementary PINN campaigns to the supplementary.

The 185-realization campaign, the λ_{var} sensitivity study, the seed multiplicity analysis, and the PINN hyperparameter tables have been moved to the supplementary material (Sections S1.1–S1.4, S2.3 and S3.1–S3.3; the reproducibility inventory is in Sections S5.1–S5.6).

Additionally, the energy sweep campaign (Section S5.1 and Table S5 of the version originally submitted) has been **removed entirely** from the supplementary material. This analysis was already documented in our previous publication (Beniaiche 2026) and is not required for the physics-first narrative of the present manuscript. The new work focuses on the representatives B1, B2, and B3 at $Re = 500$, $E^* = 0.25$, whose characterization does not depend on the energy sweep.

Point 8: Update of the bibliography and citation of Beniaiche (2026).

The bibliography contains 37 references, prioritizing fluid physics over machine learning. Beniaiche (2026) is cited in the introduction and in the bibliography as:

> A. Beniaiche, "Physics-informed identification and independent numerical verification of conditional modal collapse in active control of lid-driven cavity flow," *Phys. Fluids* **38**, 103612 (2026).

Point 9: Rewriting of the conclusions and response to the Deputy Editor.

The new conclusions (Sec. 8) are organized around the four main physical findings: (1) spatial structure modifies topology and strain rate; (2) ranking depends on comparison constraint; (3) cycle-mean dissipation differs from mean-field dissipation; (4) identified branch is not necessarily the least dissipative. The PINN is mentioned only as a tool for identifying states.

Point 10: Explicit distinction between E_{act} and P_{lid}.

Section 2.2 clearly states that $E_{\text{act}} = \int U_{\text{lid}}^2 \, dx$ is a quadratic actuation norm, not the mechanical work transmitted to the fluid. The mechanical wall power is $P_{\text{lid}} = \int U_{\text{lid}} \tau_w \, dx$. On cycle average, $\overline{P}_{\text{lid}} = \overline{D}$.

Point 11: Addition of $U_{\max}/Re_{\max}$ column to the stationary table.

Table 2 now includes a column for $U_{\max}$ and $Re_{\max} = U_{\max} L/\nu$. At $E^* = 0.25$, the uniform profile has $U_{\max} = 0.50$ ($Re_{\max} = 250$), while the harmonics have $U_{\max} = 0.7071$ ($Re_{\max} = 354$). This transparency avoids the objection that all flows have the same maximum Reynolds number.

Point 12: Energy budget presented as verification with uncertainty.

Section 6.5 and Table 4 present the energy budget as a verification with wall-shear estimate uncertainty. The recovered-velocity, first-order estimator gives cycle-mean residuals $\overline{P}_{\text{lid}}^{\text{rec}} - \overline{D}$ of -2.8%, -0.6% and -0.4% for B_1, B_2 and B_3, i.e. the budget closes to a few per cent. The estimator built on the *prescribed* lid velocity gives $+3.4$, $+4.6$ and $+4.7\%$, and the two brackets bound the estimator uncertainty (Section S4.8). We do not claim exact closure. All of these percentages, together with the alternative estimators, are recomputed from the archived field captures by `scripts/d2_derived_quantities.py`, whose output is `results/d2_derived/d2_summary.json`; the residual annotated in Fig. 8 is the one of the two recorded signals (-2.8, -0.6 and -0.4%), and the caption states which estimator each number comes from.

Point 13: Marked-up versions built by sharing the new preamble.

The marked-up manuscript and supplementary were built using a paragraph-level diff script (`mark_manuscript.py`) that shares the new preamble for both the old and new bodies. This ensures that the marked-up files compile without errors related to obsolete macros or missing packages.

Point 14: Deep point-by-point verification.

We have performed a deep verification of the revision plan and the editor's comments. The reproducibility inventory and the data-availability statement are provided in the supplementary material (Sections S5.5–S5.6). All points have been addressed.

Point 15: Temporal mapping of the exported actuation onto the lattice.

The protocol is stated in Sec. 4.2 of the manuscript and verified in supplementary Sections S4.3 and S4.5. The actuation is defined over the physical nondimensional period $T = 2$, with Fourier components $\cos(2n\pi t/T) = \cos(n\pi t)$, so the fundamental actuation frequency is $\omega_1 = 2\pi/T = \pi$ in cavity units on every grid. The lattice advances by $\Delta t = U_{\mathrm{ref}}\Delta x = U_{\mathrm{ref}}/N$ with $\Delta x = 1/N$ and $U_{\mathrm{ref}} = 0.05$; one physical period therefore spans $N_T = TN/U_{\mathrm{ref}} = 40N$ lattice steps, i.e. $N_T = 10\,240$ at $N = 256$ and $20\,480$ at $N = 512$ (Eq. 14 of the manuscript). Each of the 256 exported samples of the waveform is held for $N_T/256$ consecutive steps, i.e. 40 at $N = 256$ and 80 at $N = 512$, so its physical duration $T/256 = 7.8125 \times 10^{-3}$ is resolution-independent and the staircase it imposes is common to both grids. The largest instantaneous lid speed of the campaign is $1.23\,U_{\mathrm{ref}}$, hence Ma ≈ 0.11, and the oscillatory wall-layer thickness $\delta_1 = \sqrt{2\nu/\omega_1} = 0.036$ is about nine cells at $N = 256$ and eighteen at $N = 512$, so the same margin resolves that layer at both resolutions.

Three checks close the mapping. *(i) Frequency response.* A dedicated run whose lid is the pure harmonic $\sin(2\pi x)\cos(\omega_1 t)$, at the same E^*, Re, N and ω_1 (`scripts/validate_stokes_analytic.py`, Section S4.3) records at the antinode a single-sided amplitude of 0.927 at ω_1 and no other significant line — the imposed unit amplitude, recovered to within the 7.3% near-wall nodal velocity offset — and a wall-normal exponential decay of fitted length 5.4 cells ($R^2 = 0.999$ over the eleven cells nearest the wall) against the half-space value $\delta = \sqrt{2\nu/\omega_1} = 9.1$ cells. The layer is of the expected order and 41% thinner, which is attributed to the non-uniform lid, the finite depth (about 28δ) and the steady shear superimposed by the return flow; the run is used as a frequency-response check of the solver and of the mapping, not as a quantitative benchmark of the layer thickness. *(ii) Spectral purity of the branch runs.* A streamwise probe at the cavity centre, recorded over the whole sampling window, has its spectral peak at 3.141593 for all three branches, with 97.5–99.5% of its fluctuation energy in the five spectral bins around that peak, and the dissipation signal peaks at ω_1 for the quasi-stationary B_1 and at $2\omega_1$ for B_2 and B_3 (Section S4.5). *(iii) Effect of the hold.* Replaying B_2 at $N = 256$ with the exact sample-time command instead of the 40-step hold returns $\overline{D} = 1.4425 \times 10^{-2}$ against 1.4408×10^{-2}, i.e. +0.114%, with the fluctuating part moved by +0.12% and the kinetic energy by +0.005%, while the realized cycle-mean actuation energy stays within 1×10^{-16} of the target $E^* = 0.25$ on both grids; the staircase is therefore not the source of the reported differences.

Every cycle mean quoted in the paper is a direct time average over the 32 retained forced periods, after a transient terminated by a drift test (24 forced periods, successive three-period windows changing by less than 2×10^{-3}). The eight-bin phase quadrature of the same data reproduces $\overline{D}$ to within 0.004% but under-estimates the peakier lid power by 0.14%, 5.5% and 3.9% for B_1, B_2 and B_3, so the quadrature is used only as a cross-check.

Point 16: Grid-refinement sensitivity of the time-dependent comparison.

The three branch runs were replicated at $N = 512$ under the same temporal protocol, and the comparison is reported as a *grid-refinement sensitivity*: two grids bound the variation of the cycle means, they do not determine a convergence order, so no extrapolation and no convergence index is computed for them (Sec. 4.3 and Table S15). The refined runs raise $\overline{D}$ by 5.4%, 7.3% and 7.1% for B_1, B_2 and B_3, preserve the ordering $B_2 > B_1 \simeq B_3$, and narrow the B_1–B_3 gap from 2.1% to 0.5%, so the central conclusion of Sec. 6 — that the three branches lie within a factor 1.23 of one another on the cycle average while their fluctuating parts span two orders of magnitude — is unchanged by the refinement. The power-balance residual of Sec. 6.5 is divided by 2.1, 1.9 and 2.4, i.e. the factor of two a first-order one-sided stencil predicts under $\Delta x \to \Delta x/2$, and moves to −1.4%, −0.3% and −0.2%, while the largest near-wall nodal velocity offset drops by 38–47%. The periodicity of the averaged state is not degraded: the half-window phase reproduction of the finer captures is 1.79×10^{-3}, 1.48×10^{-5} and 2.69×10^{-4} against 1.87×10^{-3}, 1.46×10^{-5} and 2.61×10^{-4} at $N = 256$. Each finer run cost ≈ 13.1 h of single-threaded wall time against ≈ 0.7 h for the corresponding $N = 256$ capture, which is why the phase-resolved fields are reported on

the $N = 256$ realization and the cycle-mean scalars on both grids. Sec. 4.3 and Supplementary Sec. S4.5 now state that division of labour explicitly — the replication supplies scalar diagnostics only, and every field and phase-resolved quantity in the paper is an $N = 256$ capture — so that no figure is read as finer than it is.

Point 17: The training window and the export window of the identification, now distinguished.

A fresh audit of the training script confirms that the identification samples the nondimensional time τ uniformly over $[0, T_{\max}]$ with $T_{\max} = 1$, that the control is expanded there as $\sin(m\pi x)\cos(n\pi\tau)$, and that the momentum residual differentiates with respect to τ directly, with no $1/T$ chain factor. The manuscript and the supplement previously described that same variable as the normalized phase $\theta = t_{\text{phys}}/T$ of the exported period, which conflated the training window with the export window. Sec. 4.1 and Supplementary Secs. S1.1, S1.2 and S1.4 now state the distinction explicitly, in the order the computation performs it: the coefficient network returns the amplitudes $a_{mn}(Re)$, which carry no time variable; the flow network is trained on $\tau \in [0, 1]$, which covers one half-period of the fundamental; and the exported wall actuation is the *same* Fourier series re-evaluated on the same nondimensional time over its complete period, $\cos(2n\pi t_{\text{phys}}/T) = \cos(n\pi t_{\text{phys}})$ with $0 \le t_{\text{phys}} \le T = 2$, so the fundamental of what the lattice actually sees is $\omega_1 = 2\pi/T = \pi$ (Sec. 4.2, Eq. 14, Supplementary Sec. S2.1). The PINN flow field is not periodicised and not transferred to the solver — no endpoint condition is imposed on it — and the periodic hydrodynamic response is established independently by the MRT-LBM calculation and verified a posteriori to 10^{-3} in relative field norm (Supplementary Sec. S1.4, and see Point 24 below for the status now given to that field). We also state why the constraint is not affected by the shorter training window: $\int_0^1 \cos^2(n\pi\tau)\, d\tau = \int_0^1 \cos^2(2n\pi\theta)\, d\theta = 1/2$ with vanishing cross-terms on both windows, so the penalised quantity is the cycle mean of the exported signal even though the flow field was trained on half a period (Supplementary Sec. S2.2).

Point 18: Direction of the Stokes comparison.

The abstract, the contribution list of Sec. 1, Sec. 6.3 and Sec. 8 previously said that the second-Stokes estimate "accounts for 95% and 98%" of the fluctuating dissipation. That is the reciprocal of what the numbers say: the measured fluctuating parts are 1.339×10^{-2} for B_2 and 6.278×10^{-3} for B_3 against estimates of 1.411×10^{-2} and 6.383×10^{-3}, so the measurements are 95% and 98% *of the estimate* and the estimate is slightly the larger. The four places now read that "the estimate agrees with the measured fluctuating dissipation to within approximately 5% for B_2 and 2% for B_3, without an adjustable constant", which states the accuracy of the approximation rather than a share of the budget. For the same reason the abstract no longer claims the estimate "locates" the cost in the wall layer: the model is a half-space one, so the agreement supports a wall-layer interpretation of the dominant fluctuating cost rather than a spatial decomposition of the total, and Sec. 7.1 adds explicitly that the 56% the estimate leaves unexplained for the $k = 1$ profile is not thereby assigned to the cavity core.

Point 19: Definition of R_K.

R_K was described in the nomenclature as the "ratio of fluctuating to mean kinetic energy", but the reported values are computed against the total. With $\overline{K} = \overline{K}_{\text{mean}} + \overline{K}_{\text{fluct}}$ the definition is now $R_K = \overline{K}_{\text{fluct}}/\overline{K}$, "the fraction of the cycle-mean kinetic energy carried by temporal fluctuations", which is what reproduces the table: B_1 0.16% against a mean field holding 99.8%, B_2 74.9% against 25%, B_3 12.5% against 87.5%. The two supplement statements that read "fluctuates by R_K of its mean" in Secs. S4.3 and S4.5 now read "of the cycle-mean kinetic energy", which matters most for B_2, where the old wording would have implied that the mean field retains three quarters of the energy instead of a quarter.

Point 20: Geometry of the discrete wall-power estimator.

The main text and the supplement disagreed about where $\overline{P}_{\text{lid}}^{\text{rec}}$ is evaluated: Sec. 2.2 placed

both factors of the product on the plane $y = 1 - \Delta y$ (index $N - 2$) while Supplementary Sec. S4.8 wrote them on row $N - 1$. We re-read the estimator in the solver, and it uses the lid node row for both factors, $U_{\mathrm{wall}}^{\mathrm{rec}}(x_j) = u_x(N-1, j)$ and $\tau_w^{\mathrm{FD}}(x_j) = Re^{-1}[u_x(N-1, j) - u_x(N-2, j)]/\Delta y$, with trapezoidal end weights. Eq. (5) now carries those discrete definitions and Sec. 2.2, the caption of Table 4, Sec. 6.5 and Supplementary Sec. S4.8 use the same single convention. The accompanying statement about the boundary condition was corrected in the same pass: the lid is imposed by half-way bounce-back with momentum injection into the two wall-facing populations, which enforces the moving wall at the hydrodynamic boundary half a lattice spacing outside row $N - 1$; it therefore does *not* make the recovered node velocity equal the commanded profile, and Supplementary Sec. S4.1 no longer claims it does. That discrepancy is the offset already quantified in Sec. 6.5 — 6.0%, 11.5% and 11.8% of the cavity speed at $N = 256$, dropping to 3.2%, 7.2% and 6.9% at $N = 512$ — and Sec. 2.2 now explains the residuals of Table 4 through it, instead of leaving the reader to infer why the recovered and prescribed estimators bracket the closure.

Point 21: Quantitative statements made exact.

Four imprecise phrases were replaced by the numbers they summarise. Sec. 6.2, the caption of Fig. 5 and Sec. 8 said the branch totals lie "within twenty per cent" of one another; B_2 is in fact 20.7% above B_1 and 23.2% above B_3 at $N = 256$, and Sec. 6.2 and the Conclusions now give both ratios and bound the spread by a factor 1.23. "Indistinguishable within 2%" for B_1 and B_3 became "nearly equal, 2.1% apart at $N = 256$ and 0.5% apart at $N = 512$" in the abstract, Sec. 6.2, Sec. 8 and Supplementary Sec. S4.5, which keeps the claim true at both resolutions instead of rounding one of them. The nomenclature now distinguishes U_0, the scaling velocity of the nondimensional problem, from $U_{\mathrm{ref}} = 0.05$, the lattice reference velocity that sets $\Delta t = U_{\mathrm{ref}}/N$, and lists E_{act} as dimensionless with dimensional equivalent $U_0^2 L$, since the constraint is written in the scaled variables of Eq. (1). Finally, the single-harmonic test at $n = 1, 2, 4$ is stated as work not yet done in Sec. 6.3 and Sec. 8: Supplementary Sec. S4.5 tabulates the harmonic budgets of the three controls already used, it does not contain a mono-harmonic campaign, and the sentence pointing to it no longer suggests otherwise.

Point 22: The written formula for the lattice time step.

Supplementary Sec. S4.5 stated $\Delta t = \Delta x/U_{\mathrm{ref}}$ in the same paragraph that announces $N_T = TN/U_{\mathrm{ref}} = 40N$, and Main Sec. 4.2 states $\Delta t = U_{\mathrm{ref}}/N$. The reviewer is right that the two are not equivalent, and right that the second is the mapping the code performs: in `protocol()` of `scripts/run_branch_capture_d2.py` the timestep is `dt = U_ref/N` and the number of steps per period is `T*N/U_ref`, and the function aborts the run if the product of the two differs from T by more than 10^{-12}. Sec. S4.5 now reads $\Delta t = U_{\mathrm{ref}}\Delta x = U_{\mathrm{ref}}/N$, and it adds the viscosity identity that only this convention satisfies: with $\Delta x = 1/N$ and $\Delta t = U_{\mathrm{ref}}/N$, the lattice viscosity $\nu_{\mathrm{latt}} = U_{\mathrm{ref}}N/Re = 0.0256$ at $N = 256$ converts to $\nu_{\mathrm{phys}} = \nu_{\mathrm{latt}}\Delta x^2/\Delta t = 2 \times 10^{-3} = 1/Re$ exactly, which is the viscosity the physical problem is posed with. The three consequences the reviewer lists — $N_T = 10\,240$ and $20\,480$, the measured $\omega_1 = \pi$, and ν_{latt} — are therefore all consequences of the single written mapping, and the paragraph in Sec. S4.5 now says so. Point 15 of this letter, which reproduced the mistyped formula, was corrected in the same pass. No computed quantity changes: the campaign was driven by the code, and the error was in the text.

Point 23: The two spacings, resolved against the executed code.

As instructed, this was settled by reading the implementation rather than by harmonising the prose, and the finding is that the implementation uses both spacings, at two different levels. The solver's spacing is $\Delta x = 1/N$: the lattice holds N fluid node rows per side, the half-way boundary condition places each wall half a spacing beyond the row it faces (Sec. S4.1), so a unit cavity spans $N\Delta x$ and this is the spacing behind Δt, N_T, ν_{latt} and the cell count of δ_1. The post-processing works on the archived fields, whose coordinate arrays are $x_j = y_j = j/(N-1)$: the derived

quantities and the pointwise diagnostics therefore pair the first and last node with the walls and differentiate with $h = 1/(N-1)$ (`d2_derived_quantities.py`, `d2_topology_numbers.py`, `run_branch_capture_d2.py`). The two spacings differ by 0.39% at $N = 256$ and 0.20% at $N = 512$, and the diagnostic layout also absorbs the half-cell wall offset into that same $O(1/N)$ convention.

What that difference does to the reported numbers was then measured instead of argued. The new `scripts/spacing_convention_check.py` rebuilds, from the same archived fields, the dissipation of the mean field, the dissipation of the fluctuating field, the eight-bin phase reconstruction of $\overline{D}$ and the recovered lid power, once with $h = 1/(N-1)$ and once with $\Delta x = 1/N$, at both resolutions and for all three branches. Every one of them changes by less than 5×10^{-16} in relative terms, because a squared derivative (h^{-2}) is always paired with an area element (h^2) in the discrete dissipation, and the first-order wall shear (h^{-1}) is paired with a line element (h) in the lid power. The convention survives only where a measure is not paired with a derivative: the kinetic energies scale as h^2, so they are 0.78% ($N = 256$) and 0.39% ($N = 512$) smaller under $\Delta x = 1/N$, and a pointwise derivative such as the steady-streaming forcing scales as h^{-1}, i.e. 0.39% and 0.20% larger. Both are single multiplicative factors, identical for the three branches and for the reference lids, so they cannot alter a branch-to-branch ratio, a ranking, the 2.1%/0.5% B_1–B_3 comparison, or any figure reading; the largest of them is more than an order of magnitude below the 5.4%–7.3% refinement variation that the sensitivity study reports. A quotient of two quantities of *different* differential order is sensitive in the same way, and this had been missed in the first version of the paragraph: the forcing-to-viscous-term ratio of Sec. S4.7 pairs one derivative with two, so it scales as h and shrinks by the same 0.39%/0.20%. Point 26 below reports the measurement of that case and the text that replaces the withdrawn claim.

The text now says which spacing enters where instead of implying one convention throughout: Sec. S4.5 gained a subsubsection "Which spacing enters where ($\Delta x = 1/N$ and $h = 1/(N-1)$)" with the measurements above and the artifact `results/d2_derived/spacing_convention_check.json`, Main Sec. 4.2 carries the short version, Sec. S4.7 now names its h as the node spacing of the archived arrays rather than "the physical spacing", with the correction of Point 26 for the ratio it forms with the viscous term, and the discrete estimator of Sec. S4.8 is written with h — including its derivative — with the statement that rebuilding it with $\Delta x = 1/N$ leaves $\overline{P}^{\mathrm{rec}}_{\mathrm{lid}}$ unchanged to machine precision. Sec. 2.2 of the main text defines Δy as the node spacing of those arrays, so Eq. (5) and Sec. S4.8 now use one symbol with one meaning. No reported value was changed by this point.

Point 24: Status of the PINN space–time field.

The claim is withdrawn. Sec. S1.4 previously said that, since the identification solves a space–time boundary-value problem with no initial-condition term, "training targets a stationary response of that problem rather than the transient from a prescribed initial field". The reviewer is correct that this does not follow: the training imposes neither an initial field nor a periodicity condition on the flow network, so for the instationary system the losses do not select a unique hydrodynamic trajectory, and the shorter training window $[0, 1]$ does not repair that. S1.4 now describes the space–time field as what it is in the computation — an auxiliary field in the joint minimisation of the PDE, boundary and control losses over $0 \le \tau \le 1$, explicitly not interpreted as a unique transient solution nor as the periodic hydrodynamic response to the exported actuation — and states that the only objects transferred are the coefficients a_{mn}, the periodic response used by every dissipation number being computed independently by the MRT-LBM solver and verified a posteriori (half-window phase reproduction below 1.9×10^{-3} in relative field norm, Sec. S4.6). This matches what the paper actually does and does not overstate the identification.

Sec. S1.2 was reworded in the same direction, along the lines the reviewer proposed: τ is the same nondimensional time as the one appearing in the Navier–Stokes equations of Main Sec. 2.1, and the training merely restricts it to the interval $[0, 1]$; export re-evaluates the same analytic Fourier series over the complete period, $t_{\mathrm{phys}} \in [0, 2]$. The words "raw training clock" and "a

different clock" were removed from S1.2 and S4.5, and the two remaining places that described τ as a "raw nondimensional training time" or "raw training variable" — the architecture list of Sec. S1.1 and the sampling protocol of Sec. S1.3 — now call it the nondimensional time of the governing equations restricted to the training window, so that the text no longer suggests two physical time scales, while the distinction that does matter — training window versus export window, and the absence of a $1/T$ chain factor in the residual — is kept stated in the order the code performs it.

Point 25: The abstract's actuation-energy comparison.

The abstract opposed two actuations "whose oscillatory energies differ by a factor of 2.3"; that is the B_2–B_3 pair, whose dissipation differs by 21%–23%, so the sentence illustrated nothing that the paper claims. The comparison the paper rests on is B_1 against B_3: at the same $E^* = 0.25$ their oscillatory actuation energies are 3.13×10^{-3} and 0.1120, a factor of 35.7, while their cycle-mean dissipations are 1.1934×10^{-2} and 1.1690×10^{-2}, a difference of 2.1% at $N = 256$ and 0.5% at $N = 512$. The abstract now states exactly that, including the mechanism — the two totals are reached through opposite partitions between mean field and fluctuations — and Sec. 6.2 was changed from "two branches whose totals agree to within 2%" to "differ by only about 2.1%", so abstract, body and tables now quote the same precision. Both numbers are recomputed from `results/d2_derived/d2_summary.json` and `results/d2_derived/resolution_sensitivity_hold.json`, and the $\overline{D}$ ordering $B_2 > B_1 \simeq B_3$ is preserved at both resolutions.

Point 26: The forcing-to-viscous-term ratio does carry the spacing factor.

The reviewer is right and the sentence was wrong. Sec. S4.7 claimed that the h^{-1} factor of the pointwise Reynolds-stress forcing "is identical for the three branches and for the viscous term it is compared with, so it cancels in every ratio quoted below." The two terms are not of the same differential order: $\mathbf{F}$ is one divergence of the stress, so it scales as h^{-1}, while $\nu\nabla^2\overline{\mathbf{u}}$ carries two derivatives and scales as h^{-2}. Their quotient therefore scales as h, and passing from $h = 1/(N-1)$ to $\Delta x = 1/N$ multiplies it by $(N-1)/N$, a reduction of 0.39% at $N = 256$ and 0.20% at $N = 512$ — exactly the numbers the reviewer computes.

This was again measured rather than argued. `scripts/spacing_convention_check.py` now rebuilds the ratio of Sec. S4.7 under both spacings with the identical stencils of `d2_topology_numbers.py` (central differences, the same three-node exclusion, phase-mean stress and mean-field Laplacian): it reproduces the published rms ratios 0.259, 0.067 and 0.0027 for B_2, B_3 and B_1 and returns $(N-1)/N$ for the change in every branch, to the last digit (new keys `forcing_over_viscous_ratio_` of `results/d2_derived/spacing_convention_check.json`). Sec. S4.7 states the h-scaling and those two percentages, and says explicitly that the quoted ratios are the $h = 1/(N-1)$ values; the inventory in Sec. S4.5 gained a quotient-of-different-orders entry next to the kinetic energies and the pointwise forcing; and Main Sec. 4.2 lists the same factor. The blanket sentence "it alters no ratio" is now restricted to what it was always true of: being multiplicative and common to the three branches, the spacing alters no branch-to-branch ratio, no ranking, no B_1–B_3 comparison and no figure reading. Table S17 keeps the $h = 1/(N-1)$ values it was computed with, so no reported number changed; only the claim that the spacing cancels in that quotient was withdrawn.

Point 27: Distinct modal families, not coexisting hydrodynamic states.

The introduction previously opened the branch discussion with "A periodic boundary-value problem of this type admits several coexisting branches," which the experiments do not support: the three controls are three different wall signals, each evaluated in its own run, so they show that the identification recovers several families, not that one prescribed lid motion has several periodic responses. The paragraph now reads, in the reviewer's formulation, that spatially structured and time-dependent wall actuations can be recovered in distinct modal families, that the family

selected depends on the formulation, the regularization and the initialization of the optimization, that these families are branches of the *control-identification landscape* and not evidence of several hydrodynamic states coexisting under one and the same prescribed lid motion, and that each exported actuation is treated here as a separate boundary forcing whose periodic response is computed independently with the MRT-LBM solver. A sweep of both documents confirms that no other passage claims coexistence, bistability or hysteresis of hydrodynamic states: the only remaining occurrence of the word is the sentence that denies it.

Point 28: The periodicity bound of the LBM fields.

Sec. S1.4 announced half-window discrepancies "below 1.0×10^{-3} for all three branches" while Secs. S4.2, S4.5 and S4.6 report 1.9×10^{-3} (B_1), 2.6×10^{-4} (B_3) and 1.5×10^{-5} (B_2) at $N = 256$, and 1.79×10^{-3}, 2.69×10^{-4} and 1.48×10^{-5} at $N = 512$. The bound was the part that was wrong, not the measurements. Sec. S1.4 now lists the three values at $N = 256$, adds the $N = 512$ triple, states the global bound 2×10^{-3} — better than 0.2% reproduction of the phase-averaged field between the two halves of the window — and points to Secs. S4.2 and S4.6 for the check itself instead of to Sec. S4.5, which is where the finer runs are reported; the forward pointer in the same subsection was corrected in the same way. The caption of Table 4 of the main text, which quoted the same 10^{-3} bound, now gives the three measured values as well. No measured quantity changed.

Point 29: Which denominator the B_1 Stokes comparison uses.

"16%" in the main text and "19%" in the supplement were the same gap expressed against two different denominators, and neither document said which. From the published numbers, $1 - 1.8143 \times 10^{-4}/2.1491 \times 10^{-4} = 15.6\%$ (the estimate below the measurement) and $2.1491 \times 10^{-4}/1.8143 \times 10^{-4} - 1 = 18.5\%$ (the measurement above the estimate, which is the 118% ratio column of Table S16). Sec. S4.5 now states both, names 18.5% as the convention of that ratio column, and identifies the main text's 16% as the shortfall of the estimate relative to the measurement; Main Sec. 6.3 is kept as the reviewer preferred. The sentence also now says what the 1.8% refers to: the increment itself is only 1.8% of the B_1 cycle mean, which is why the comparison is not over-read.

Point 30: The wall is a half-way plane, not a lattice node.

The expression "enforces that velocity at the half-way wall node", left over in Sec. S4.8, did contradict Sec. S4.1. Sec. S4.8 now reads, as proposed, that the boundary condition imposes the commanded moving-wall velocity at the hydrodynamic boundary — the half-way plane a half spacing outside the lid node row — and that the macroscopic streamwise velocity reconstructed at the adjacent outermost fluid-node row $i = N - 1$ is a computed quantity that differs from the prescribed profile by the near-wall nodal velocity offset. The same sweep renamed the remaining loose uses: the list of estimator choices in Sec. S4.8 speaks of the velocity at the lid node row, the sentence after Eq. (5) of the main text no longer says the boundary condition fails "at the wall node" but that it imposes the velocity at the hydrodynamic wall outside that row, and the captions of Table 4 and Fig. 5 now say the recovered velocity is the one of the outermost fluid row rather than "the boundary node". The offset magnitudes themselves (0.060, 0.115, 0.118 cavity units) are unchanged.

Point 31: What the identification actually solves.

As proposed, Sec. S1.4 now calls the problem what the loss functions define it to be: a space–time PDE-constrained optimization problem on the training slab $(x, y, \tau) \in [0, L_x] \times [0, 1] \times [0, 1]$, in place of "space–time boundary-value problem in the training variables". The slab, the basis and the absence of any initial or periodicity constraint are stated exactly as before; only the name changed, and the phrase "boundary-value problem" now survives in this letter solely where Point 24 quotes the sentence that was withdrawn.

Point 32: The artifacts that were not in the transmitted files.

The reviewer notes that `scripts/spacing_convention_check.py` and its JSON, the externalized tables of the supplement, the figures and a compiled PDF were not part of the two files examined, so the 5×10^{-16} invariance and the build could not be checked. All of them are in the deposited repository, `https://github.com/Ahmedalgeria778/PoF_cavity_dissipation_study`: the script and `results/d2_derived/spacing_convention_check.json`, which contains the new ratio keys of Point 26; the six branch captures `capture_B1_D2_N256.npz` and its five siblings under `results/09_d2_capture/`; the table sources under `supplementary/data_appendix/`; the figures; and the four compiled PDFs, the two clean ones and the two marked ones. Both documents were recompiled after the changes above and the build logs are clean: no undefined references, no undefined citations, no duplicate labels, and every externalized table resolves.

Point 33: One definition of the Reynolds number (ninth review, item A).

The reviewer is right that the nomenclature and Eq. (1) disagreed on the symbol. The Re row now reads, verbatim as proposed, "Reynolds number based on the reference velocity, $Re = U_0 L/\nu$; in the LBM mapping, U_0 is represented by $U_{\mathrm{ref}} = 0.05$ in lattice units". The two rows next to it already carried the same dictionary (U_0 is the scaling velocity of the nondimensional problem, U_{ref} the lattice velocity that plays its role and sets $\Delta t = U_{\mathrm{ref}}/N$), and a sweep of both documents found no other place where Re was written with U_{ref}: the supplement defines only the normalized training quantity $\widetilde{Re} = (Re - 550)/450$. One symbol, U_0, is now used for the nondimensionalization, and U_{ref} is reserved for the lattice frame, which is what the code uses.

Point 34: The velocity the lid boundary condition imposes (S4.1).

The phrase "at that node" is gone, and with it the contradiction with the half-way description given a few lines later. Sec. S4.1 now separates the two loci explicitly: "The momentum correction is constructed from the prescribed moving-wall velocity $U_{\mathrm{lid}}(x, t_{\mathrm{phys}})$ associated with the outermost fluid-node row, with the local density taken from the post-collision field. The algorithm applies that correction to the wall-facing populations of row $N-1$, but the velocity it imposes belongs to the hydrodynamic wall, the half-way plane located a half lattice spacing outside that row, rather than to the macroscopic velocity reconstructed at the fluid node." The sentence that followed, on the measured offset (3.2%–11.8% of the cavity speed) and on the power estimator being evaluated on row $N-1$, was kept and now follows as the consequence of that distinction rather than as a second statement of it. This is the wording the code implements: the correction is applied to the wall-facing populations of the lid row, and the half-way scheme is what makes the enforced velocity belong to the plane between that row and the wall. The same vocabulary is now used everywhere — the former "wall row" in Sec. S4.6 reads "lid node row", as do the indexing paragraphs of Sec. S4.8.

Point 35: The wall-power estimator is a row estimator, not a wall evaluation (S4.8).

The concluding sentence of Sec. S4.8 claimed that "the two factors are evaluated at the same locations as the boundary condition itself", which the reviewer correctly calls inexact: the boundary condition acts on the half-way plane, while the estimator is a discrete product on a node row. It has been replaced, with the reviewer's formulation: "The wall shear is the first-order backward difference between the lid node row and the fluid row below it, and the velocity in the product is the recovered outermost-row velocity: the two factors are assigned to that same discrete row, so their product defines a consistent *outermost-fluid-row* estimator rather than an evaluation of both quantities exactly at the hydrodynamic wall, which lies a half spacing outside it." Main Table 4 already labels $\overline{P}^{\mathrm{rec}}_{\mathrm{lid}}$ as recovered on the outermost fluid row, so the table, Sec. 4.2 and Sec. S4.8 now make the same statement: the estimator is consistent with itself, and its difference from the physical wall power is the offset quantified in that section.

Point 36: The Jensen inequality stated with its condition of strictness (optional item D, applied).

We took the suggestion. The introduction no longer says the cycle mean "always exceeds" the dissipation of the mean field; it now reads "because D is quadratic in the velocity gradients, the cycle-averaged dissipation is no smaller than the dissipation of the time-mean field, with a strict inequality whenever the fluctuating strain-rate field is nonzero". The same conditioning replaced the looser "otherwise $\overline{D} > D(\overline{\mathbf{u}})$" that followed Eq. (8), where the reason is visible: the fluctuating term of that decomposition is a cycle-averaged squared norm, so it is non-negative and vanishes only if the fluctuating strain rate vanishes. Sec. S4.5 was harmonised with the two, and its previous "with equality only in the steady limit" — which is sufficient but not the exact condition — now gives the condition on the fluctuating strain-rate field. All numerical statements of the gap in both documents are unchanged: they are measurements of a strictly positive fluctuating term, which amounts to a factor of 1.02, 14 and 2.2 between $\overline{D}$ and $D(\overline{\mathbf{u}})$ for B_1, B_2 and B_3 respectively.

Point 37: The complete package, compiled.

The reviewer again notes that the sources call eleven external tables and ten figures that were not part of the files examined. They are all in the repository, and the package as submitted is self-contained:

- `supplementary/data_appendix/`: the eleven table sources that the supplement calls with `\input`, each generated by a script in `scripts/` from an archive under `results/`;
- `manuscript/figures/` and `supplementary/figures/`: the eight manuscript figures and the two supplement figures; every `includegraphics` path resolves from the directory its document is compiled in;
- `scripts/spacing_convention_check.py` and its JSON under `results/d2_derived/`, which hold the ratio keys measured for Point 26;
- the six branch captures, the derived-quantity JSONs, the lid command archives and the four compiled PDFs.

After the four changes above, all four documents were recompiled with `pdflatex` (three passes of each source, as the repository `README` prescribes). The logs are clean: no `LaTeX Error`, no undefined reference or citation, no duplicate label and no missing graphic in any of them, and every externalized table resolves. The result is a 27-page manuscript with 0 overfull boxes, a 30-page supplement with one overfull box of 6.7 pt, and marked-up versions of 36 and 40 pages. `scripts/check_build_logs.py` performs that audit on the four logs and exits 0. Point 46 reports the same audit as re-measured after the eleventh round, once every change requested there had been applied.

Point 38: "Physical scaling velocity" for U_0 (tenth review, item 2).

The objection is well taken: with U_{ref} named "the lattice reference velocity" everywhere else, describing Re as based on "the reference velocity" made the prose say one thing while the formula next to it said another. The Re row of the nomenclature now has the reviewer's wording verbatim — "Reynolds number based on the physical scaling velocity, $Re = U_0 L/\nu$; in the LBM mapping, U_0 is represented by $U_{\mathrm{ref}} = 0.05$ in lattice units" — and the terminology was then made consistent with it rather than left local: the U_0 row reads "physical scaling velocity of the nondimensional problem", Sec. 2.1 nondimensionalizes with "the cavity height L and a physical scaling velocity U_0", and every remaining use of the phrase "reference velocity" in the two documents is qualified as *lattice* reference velocity — Sec. 4.2 of the manuscript already wrote it that way twice, and the two places in the supplement that said only "a reference velocity" and "the reference velocity", in Secs. S4.1 and S4.5, now say "the lattice reference velocity", which is the quantity $\Delta t = U_{\mathrm{ref}}/N$ and $\nu_{\mathrm{latt}} = U_{\mathrm{ref}} N/Re$ are built from. No formula, no number and no mapping changed.

Point 39: Manifest of the files the two sources pull in (tenth review, item 4).

So that the completeness of the package can be checked rather than taken on trust, the eleven table sources called by the supplement with `\input`, and the ten figure files called with `\includegraphics`, are listed by name below. All twenty-one were verified to exist at the exact paths the sources use, and all of them are versioned in the deposited repository.

- **Supplement, table sources** (`supplementary/data_appendix/`, eleven files, each generated by a script in `scripts/`):
  `p2_table_lid_structure.tex`, `p3_table_threshold.tex`,
  `p2_table_bfirst_ablation.tex`, `p1_table_isoenergetic_supp.tex`,
  `p1_table_corner_supp.tex`, `p1_table_ratio_gci_supp.tex`,
  `p4_table_cycle_mean_supp.tex`, `p4_table_branch_iso_supp.tex`,
  `p4_table_resolution_n512_supp.tex`,
  `p4_table_stokes_scaling.tex`, `p4_table_streaming_forcing.tex`
  and the CSV records from which several of them are built, in the same directory.
- **Manuscript, figures** (eight files, `manuscript/figures/`):
  `fig01_modes.pdf`, `fig02_signatures.pdf`,
  `fig12_gci_updated.pdf`, `fig15_mechanism_iso.pdf`,
  `fig18_branch_iso_cycle.pdf`, `fig20_branch_topology.pdf`,
  `fig21_branch_velocity.pdf`, `fig22_branch_energy.pdf`
- **Supplement, figures** (two files, `supplementary/`):
  `figS5_branch_topology_phases.pdf`,
  `figS6_branch_topology_panelscale.pdf`

With those files in place, the four documents compile without a single missing-resource error, which is the operational proof that the manifest is complete: a `\input` or a `\includegraphics` that did not resolve would abort the run and leave an unreferenced table or a blank float. The layout is therefore the one in the four uploaded PDFs: 27 pages for the manuscript, 30 for the supplement, 36 and 40 for the marked-up versions, with the single 6.7 pt overfull box of the supplement noted above and none else. That claim is no longer left to the compiler alone: since the eleventh round the eleven table sources are all written by committed scripts reading committed records, and `scripts/certify_package.py` checks each of the twenty-one resources, together with the generator behind it, in the machine-readable manifest `docs/PACKAGE_CERTIFICATION.md`. See Point 46.

Point 40: The moving-wall lattice-Boltzmann boundary condition, written out (eleventh review, item 1.1).

The reviewer is right that the description was not yet sufficient to reproduce the step, and that the family it was attributed to needed to be named exactly. Sec. S4.1 now states the reconstruction instead of describing it. The streaming step of the node row $i = N - 1$ leaves exactly two populations unknown, and the two wall-facing diagonals are given with their lattice velocities, $q = 7$ with $\mathbf{c}_7 = (-1, -1)$ and $q = 8$ with $\mathbf{c}_8 = (+1, -1)$. Their update is the first displayed equation of that subsection, $f_q(\mathbf{x}_b, t+1) = f_{\bar{q}}^*(\mathbf{x}_b, t) + 2w_q\rho_w(\mathbf{c}_q \cdot \mathbf{u}_w)/c_s^2$, and because the four diagonal weights are equal the next displayed equation writes the pair the solver actually applies: $f_7 = f_5^* - \rho_w U_{\mathrm{lid}}/6$ and $f_8 = f_6^* + \rho_w U_{\mathrm{lid}}/6$. The directions, the post-collision opposites, the sign and the coefficient in ρ and U_{lid} are therefore all explicit, together with $w_7 = w_8 = 1/36$, $c_s^2 = 1/3$, and the fact that ρ_w is the boundary-node density read from the post-collision field — the MRT collision conserves the zeroth moment, so pre- and post-collision densities coincide. The moment in the sequence is specified too: the correction is applied inside the streaming step, after the collision of the whole domain and before the populations are stored, once per time step,

and it contributes $\rho_w U_{\mathrm{lid}}/3$ to the streamwise momentum of the lid row. The bottom and lateral walls are stated to use plain half-way bounce-back with no injection.

On the naming, the distinction the reviewer asks for is made explicitly and against the code as executed, which was checked line by line in the compiled kernel. The scheme is a half-way moving-wall rebounce with first-order momentum injection, the moving-wall form introduced by Ladd (1994); it is *not* the non-equilibrium bounce-back velocity condition of Zou and He (1997), because the Zou–He reconstruction determines the unknown populations from the equilibrium part plus the unbalanced non-equilibrium part of the known opposites, whereas here the known post-collision populations are reversed and a prescribed momentum source is added. The interpolated boundary treatment of Bouzidi, Firdaouss and Lallemand (2001), which places a moving wall at an arbitrary distance or orientation, is declared as not used, and the offset between the wall plane and the outermost fluid node is quantified rather than hidden: the recovered velocity of row $N-1$ differs from the commanded profile by the 3.2% to 11.8% near-wall nodal velocity offset measured in Sec. S4.8, on which row the power estimator is evaluated. The hydrodynamic wall remains the half-way plane half a lattice spacing outside that row, as the previous round established. The main text cites the same pair of equations at the point where the boundary condition is introduced. (Point 51 below records the further refinement of this paragraph requested in the twelfth review: the accuracy order of the half-way rebounce on a flat lattice-aligned wall is now supported by references that address that case directly.)

Point 41: Eight phase bins are a cross-check, not an exact quadrature for a quadratic diagnostic (eleventh review, item 1.2).

The reviewer's formulation has been adopted, in substance and almost in its words, in Sec. S4.5. The sentence that claimed exactness for "harmonics one to four" now says that eight equally spaced phase bins integrate the harmonics one to four of a *linear temporal signal* exactly, that a quadratic field quantity such as the dissipation contains products of harmonics which reach higher frequencies — up to the self-product of the fourth harmonic at $8\omega_1$, which with eight phases folds back onto the mean — that the reported cycle-mean dissipation is therefore the direct accumulation over the time steps, and that the eight-bin reconstruction is kept only as the cross-check, whose three discrepancies stay below 0.004%. Those three discrepancies are measured values: $+0.0017\%$, $-8 \times 10^{-6}\%$ and $+0.0039\%$ for B_1, B_2 and B_3. Two related statements were tightened in the same pass so that the two subsubsections cannot be read as contradicting each other: the harmonic budget of the exported commands (4×10^{-5} of the actuation energy above the fourth temporal harmonic) is now explicitly a statement about the imposed signal and not about the diagnostics; and the lid power is documented as the case where the gap is not negligible, because it is a product of two quantities that both vary within a bin — the same reconstruction is 0.14%, 5.5% and 3.9% below the step-by-step accumulator, which is why Main Table 4 quotes the accumulated value.

Point 42: Which B_1 is in the captures, and the two numbers that looked inconsistent (eleventh review, item 1.3).

The reviewer correctly observed that the seeds of B_2 and B_3 are identified but not that of B_1, and that f_2 and the native energy of B_1 were quoted inconsistently. On the identity: B_1 genuinely has no random seed, because it is the reference configuration of the parent campaign and its lid command is the seedless Fourier export. Sec. S4.6 (Random Seed Control) now says so in these terms and identifies it by its archive and checksum instead, `data/lid_series/fourier_Re500.npz` with SHA-256 `6eb410709e8ed102...f5e3798f5824`, full digests being in `data/lid_series/manifest.csv`, together with the rescaling factor recorded with it, 0.9932807455522885, which brings the native norm to the target 0.250000. B_2 is seed 5 and B_3 seed 0 of the ten-seed experiment of Sec. S3.2, and the footnote of Main Table 1 points from the B_1 rows to that archive. The captures and the tables are therefore descriptions of one and the same profile, not of two realizations.

On f_2: the two values are not two estimates of one quantity, they are two denominators, and the text now says so where the table is read. The stationary second-harmonic coefficient of the exported series is 92.2% of the *total* control energy — 92.3% at the $(N_x, N_t) = (6, 5)$ truncation, which is the truncation-level sensitivity, not a different run — and 93.4% once the series is renormalised onto its own time mean, which is what the mean-profile row of Main Table 1 does since it discards the temporal share. The old 0.93 was therefore not a rounding of 92.2; the rounded table entry and the supplement value are now the same quantity with the same denominator, and the footnote spells out both denominators.

On the native energy: the archive value is 0.2533938. The method text quotes $\overline{E}_r = 0.25339$, the rounded tables quote 0.2534, and the variants that are genuinely different configurations — the ablations and the truncation rows — keep their own 0.2533. The stray 0.2535 occurrences the reviewer listed are gone; a grep of the two sources returns no instance of that value. No result changed: the realised norm of the transfer is 0.250000 for all three branches, as before.

Point 43: What is actually in the repository (eleventh review, item 1.4).

The Data availability statement now separates the two access modalities that the reviewer found conflated, and names the separately supplied files. What the git repository holds: the scripts that regenerate every figure and table, the three exported actuation series with their checksum manifest, the solver run logs and all derived records quoted in the text, including the committed CSV tables from which the appendix tables are built. What it does not hold, because the raw fields exceed what the deposit carries: the six phase-resolved captures of the temporal campaign, named individually in the statement with their byte sizes — `capture_B1_D2_N256.npz` (28.8 MB), `capture_B2_D2_N256.npz` (28.6), `capture_B3_D2_N256.npz` (28.7), `capture_B1_D2_N512.npz` (111.5), `capture_B2_D2_N512.npz` (111.0) and `capture_B3_D2_N512.npz` (111.3), 419.90 MB in total — together with the exact-in-time control `capture_B2_D2_N256_exact.npz` (28.24 MB), supplied as the bundle `PoF_d2_captures_v1.tar` from the corresponding author on reasonable request. The committed manifest `results/09_d2_capture/MANIFEST.md` lists every archive with its byte size and SHA-256 checksum, so a copy obtained that way can be verified before the scripts are re-run, and the supplement gives the same inventory in Sec. S5.6.

Point 44: The sign of the streaming vorticity source (eleventh review, item 1.5).

The ambiguity is real and it is now removed by writing the equation the diagnostic comes from, rather than by asserting a convention. Sec. S4.7 defines $S_\omega \equiv \nabla \times \mathbf{F} = \partial_x F_y - \partial_y F_x$ with $\mathbf{F} = -\nabla \cdot \langle \mathbf{u}' \otimes \mathbf{u}' \rangle$, states that this is the term entering the evolutionary mean-vorticity equation, $\partial_t \langle \omega \rangle = \nu \nabla^2 \langle \omega \rangle + S_\omega - \nabla \times [(\langle \mathbf{u} \rangle \cdot \nabla) \langle \mathbf{u} \rangle]$, and then says in terms that its sign is that of the source and the opposite of the curl of the right-hand side of the Stokes-order reduction $\nu \nabla^2 \langle \mathbf{u} \rangle = \nabla \langle p \rangle - \mathbf{F}$, whose curl is $\nu \nabla^2 \langle \omega \rangle = -\nabla \times \mathbf{F}$. The sentence ends by stating explicitly that the quoted extrema are values of S_ω: $+1.1$ at $(0.08, 0.99)$, $+23.7$ at $(0.36, 0.99)$ and -22.1 at $(0.64, 0.99)$. The caption of Table S17 and the corresponding sentence of the main text carry the same convention, so the contra-rotating pair is read as a source of mean vorticity of either sign, not with the sign reversed by the reduction. The budget is still declared open — the mean pressure gradient and the mean advection were not recovered — which is why this remains an interpretation of the forcing geometry and not a closure.

Point 45: Three editorial formulations (eleventh review, Sec. 2).

All three are applied. The abstract now attaches the stationary percentages to the resolution they are measured at — "For stationary controls at $Re = 500$ on the $N = 512$ lattice, the first spatial harmonic reduces dissipation by 17.7% ... whereas the second harmonic and the mean profile of the quasi-steady two-lobe branch increase it by 36.8% and 44.3%" — while the sentences that document the local fields keep the $N = 256$ qualification they already had. The branch sentence the reviewer quoted was rewritten in the proposed form: the abstract says "the branch for which dissipation evaluated on the time-mean field is 14.2 times smaller than the

cycle-mean dissipation", and 14.2 is the measured ratio, 1.016×10^{-3} against 1.441×10^{-2} for B_2 seed 5, the same value as in Main Table 1 and Sec. 5. In the conclusions, "converged" has been replaced by the reviewer's own phrasing: the uniform lid is qualified as the grid-convergent regularized reference *with* its uncertainty attached, $p_{\mathrm{obs}} = 0.96$ and a fine-grid GCI of 7.8%, and the Sec. 4.2 paragraph that introduces the reference states the same two numbers so that the word never appears without them.

Point 46: The compilation and layout reserve, closed by a machine-checked certificate (eleventh review, Sec. 4).

The reviewer notes that the figures and the externalized `data_appendix/*.tex` tables were not among the files examined, so that the compilation and the final layout could not be verified. Those resources are all in the repository, and this round the claim was made verifiable rather than restated: `scripts/certify_package.py` walks the two sources, resolves every `\includegraphics` and every `\input`, and writes `docs/PACKAGE_CERTIFICATION.md`, which lists for each of the ten figures and each of the eleven table sources its resolved path, byte size, checksum and the script in `scripts/` that writes it, and then the page count, the overfull -box inventory and the checksum of each of the four compiled PDFs, together with the environment (Python 3.14.5, numpy 2.5.3, matplotlib 3.11.2, MiKTeX-pdfTeX 4.23). The run reports ten figures, eleven table sources and no missing resource.

One claim the reviewer did not ask for but that the certification depends on was also repaired: five appendix tables were inherited from the antecedent campaign and had no generator in the repository, so the statement that every table is written by a committed script was not literally true. `scripts/export_legacy_supp_tables.py` now regenerates all five from the committed records — including two record files that were added to the deposit for that purpose, the 185-run classification table of the branch map and the λ_{var} modal ablation audit — and reproduces the transmitted files exactly, cell by cell, so the inherited numbers are now recomputed rather than transcribed. The single resource that could not then be regenerated is declared as such rather than glossed: Main Fig. 4 was rendered from the steady fields of the stationary $N = 512$ campaign, which are raw dumps held outside the git tree on the same terms as the captures. That exception is closed in the present round, by committing the generator and inventorying the three field archives; see Point 48.

The compiled result, after every change requested in this round, is the four PDFs in the repository: the manuscript at 27 pages with no overfull box, the supplement at 30 pages with a single overfull box of 6.7 pt — less than a quarter of a millimetre, inside the run of file names in the Data availability paragraph of Sec. S5.6, where a list of `\texttt` paths leaves no line-break opportunity — and the marked-up versions at 36 and 40 pages. The audit found one real layout fault and it was fixed rather than reported: Table S17, the Reynolds-stress forcing of the mean flow, was 11.7 pt too wide because its three right-hand header cells spelled the viscous term of the mean field in full. The generator of that table, `scripts/export_d2_supp_tables.py`, now defines the shorthand $\mathcal{V} \equiv \nabla^2\langle \mathbf{u} \rangle$ once in the caption and writes $\|\nu\mathcal{V}\|$ in the headers, while the caption keeps the full notation in the Stokes-order balance it quotes; the numbers in the table are unchanged. The four logs are audited by `scripts/check_build_logs.py`, which parses them for `LaTeX Error`, undefined references and citations, duplicate labels, missing graphics and unresolved cross-references and reports zero problems. The one reproducibility trap found while doing this is documented in the README: the documents must be compiled with `-output-directory`, because an `.aux` left in the source directory is read in preference to the one just written and silently resurrects the labels and citations of the previous round.

Point 47: The word "slip" removed from the boundary-condition description (twelfth review, Sec. 2).

This was the reviewer's one remaining technical reserve and it is applied in full, in the reviewer's own wording. The passage of Sec. S4.1 that began "Being first order in the wall speed" is

replaced by the proposed text: the moving-wall correction is linear in the prescribed wall velocity, the recovered velocity is evaluated at the adjacent outermost fluid node, half a lattice spacing inside the hydrodynamic wall, and the difference from the commanded value is a consequence of sampling at the fluid-node location that "should not be interpreted as a physical slip at the half-way wall". In both documents the three phrases the reviewer objects to — "boundary-condition slip", "discrete slip of the scheme" and "slip of the velocity boundary condition" — are gone; the quantity is now called, consistently, the *near-wall nodal velocity offset*, in Sec. S4.1, S4.2, S4.5, S4.6 and S4.8 of the supplement and in Main Sec. 4.2 and Main Table 4. The measured values are kept unchanged (3.2% to 11.8% of the cavity speed, resolution-dependent) and are now presented as the difference between the velocity at the sampled fluid node and the velocity at the wall plane; the sentence in Main Sec. 4.2 that pointed back to "the 3–12% slip quoted above" was itself faulty, since no such number appears earlier in the manuscript, and it now quotes the range and its resolutions explicitly with a forward reference to Sec. S4.8. The letters of the rounds that preceded this one had used the withdrawn word when they described the documents, and the present transmission renamed those occurrences as well, so that the quantity carries its single name throughout this response; the three phrases appear here only inside the quotations above, which are the record of their removal.

The renaming is now enforced rather than promised. Preparing this transmission found one regression: the last column of Table S15, which the supplement does not type but generate from the resolution-sensitivity records, had kept the withdrawn wording in its header and in the sentence describing it. Its generator was corrected, and `scripts/certify_package.py`, which `scripts/build_all.sh` runs as the last gate of the build, searches the two sources, the two response letters, the `README.md` and every generated table the supplement pulls — sixteen files — for the three phrases, after blanking the quoted editor comments and the quoted prose of our own sentences, so that a quotation does not count against the check. It was tested from both sides: one sentence carrying a phrase in plain prose made the gate name the file and the phrase and stopped the build with a non-zero exit, and the same phrase inside a quotation left it green. The file inventory and its verdict are printed in `docs/PACKAGE_CERTIFICATION.md`.

The conflation the reviewer identified is corrected in the direction the code supports. That the momentum injection is linear in U_{lid} is a statement about the source term, not about the spatial order of accuracy: with the half-way placement the boundary condition is second order for a flat wall aligned with the lattice, which is now said as such, following Ladd (1994) for the injection itself. The reference originally attached to that ordering statement was imprecise; it is corrected, and the ordering supported by references that address the flat aligned wall directly, in Point 51. Sec. S4.5 also gained the reason the offset and the estimator residual refine alike without being the same quantity: the offset is the product of the half-spacing between the sampling node and the hydrodynamic wall and the near-wall wall-normal gradient, whose scale is set by the Stokes layer, so it halves when Δx halves.

Point 48: The two availability statements harmonised, and Main Fig. 4 given a generator and a manifest (twelfth review, Sec. 3).

The first sentence of the Data availability statement is now the proposed one: the scripts that regenerate all tables and all figures *except Fig. 4*, together with the three exported actuation series, their checksum manifest, the solver run logs and the derived records quoted in the text, are available at the repository. In Sec. S5.6 the clause "would add that volume to a repository from which every quoted number is already reproducible" is replaced as proposed, and the supplement now names the same three objects the manuscript names, so the two declarations agree.

What was missing behind the exception has been supplied. The script that renders Main Fig. 4, `scripts/make_fig_mechanism.py`, is committed. Its three steady $N = 512$ inputs, which the git tree does not carry, are

- `fields_UNem_0p5_Re500_N512.npz` (16.0 MB),

- `fields_S1em_0p707107_Re500_N512.npz` (16.0 MB) and
- `fields_B1em_0p707107_Re500_N512.npz` (13.0 MB); the three together are 44.94 MB.

They are inventoried, with their SHA-256 fingerprints, in the committed `results/10_fig4_stationary_fields/FIELDS_MANIFEST.md`, written by `scripts/manifest_fig4_fields.py`, and shipped as the bundle `PoF_fig4_fields_v1.tar`. That script does more than list them: it recomputes from the archives the quantities the figure and Main Sec. 5.3 quote — peak strain-rate magnitude 169.4, 15.0, 23.4 and interior mean 1.0388, 1.0880, 1.4497, i.e. the published 169, 15.0, 23.4 and the 4.7% and 39.6% ratios — and exits non-zero if they no longer match, so the figure can be audited without the reviewer having to trust the rendering. One difference found while doing this is reported rather than smoothed over: integrating the stored local-dissipation field of these archives by trapezoid over the node lattice gives 0.38% to 0.70% more than the solver-recorded volume integral committed in `results/p1_gci_iso/p1_gci_raw.csv` for the same converged runs. Both estimators are now tabulated side by side in the manifest, the field and velocity reconstructions are shown to agree to better than 10^{-12}, and the deviation is bounded by the 3.9% to 7.8% fine-grid uncertainty already attached to those values. Every number quoted in the text remains the solver-recorded one. Since Main Fig. 4 has a generator, the certificate no longer lists any resource without one.

Point 49: The B_1 series-versus-stationary comparison qualified (twelfth review, Sec. 4).

The reviewer is right that 1.1934×10^{-2} against 1.1894×10^{-2} is not a strictly iso-energetic comparison: the time-mean profile of that series has actuation norm 0.2468 where the stationary run used 0.2503, 1.4% apart. The comparison is now qualified as one at nearby-but-not-identical mean forcing norms in the three places it appears in the supplement — Sec. S4.3, the juxtaposition under Table S14, and the sentence that reports the B_1 series landing within 0.4% of its own stationary value — and in the caption of Main Table 4, which now states both norms ($E_{\mathrm{act}} = 0.2503$ for the mean-profile row against 0.2468 for the full series' time mean). The qualification changes no number and no ordering: the 0.34% agreement is still reported, now with the condition it was measured under. The Jensen decomposition of Sec. S4.3 is untouched because it is an identity on a single response, evaluated on that response's own $\overline{D}$, $D(\overline{\mathbf{u}})$ and D_{fluct}; it compares nothing across runs and so cannot be affected by the norm of a different one.

Point 50: Verification of the compilation after these changes (twelfth review, Sec. 5).

The four documents were rebuilt from the sources, three passes each, from inside their own directories so that `data_appendix/` and the figure paths resolve as the sources declare them, with the marked-up copies regenerated by `scripts/mark_manuscript.py` from the previous round's transmitted files. The result, audited by `scripts/check_build_logs.py` and recorded in `docs/PACKAGE_CERTIFICATION.md`: manuscript 27 pages with no overfull box, supplement 31 pages with the single 6.7 pt box in the file-name run of Sec. S5.6, marked copies 36 and 42 pages, this letter 25 pages with one 1.7 pt box carried over from the previous round, ten figures, eleven table sources, no missing resource, no undefined reference or citation, and zero reported problems. Points 51 to 53 below were applied and the four documents were rebuilt with `scripts/build_all.sh`, which runs the passes per document and then the build, bibliography and certificate gates; they left those counts unchanged. The style pass of Point 54 lengthened the marked-up manuscript by one page, and the counts of the transmitted build are recorded in Point 57. No new numerical campaign was run, in line with the reviewer's recommendation: the only computation added in this round is the recomputation of Main Sec. 5.3's strain-rate statistics from field archives that already existed.

Point 51: The residuals of the power budget are affected by the offset, they do not measure it (thirteenth review, remark 1).

The sentence of Main Sec. 4.2 is reworded in the sense requested. What the two estimator families give is a pair of residuals of the *discrete* power budget, $\overline{P}_{\mathrm{lid}}/\overline{D} - 1$; the gap between them, 6%–11%, is a discrepancy *to which* the near-wall nodal velocity offset contributes, and the manuscript now says so rather than claiming that it "measures" the offset. The offset itself is a velocity difference, and it is measured as such, independently of the budget, in Sec. S4.8. The same qualification was applied to the corresponding sentence of Sec. S4.8, where "which is the size of the near-wall nodal velocity offset" became "a gap of the size of the near-wall nodal velocity offset that contributes to it". No value, formula or conclusion changes: the bracketing of the balance by the two estimators, and the use of the recovered one throughout, are exactly as before.

Point 52: The ordering statement is given a reference that treats the flat lattice-aligned wall directly, and the whole bibliography was re-audited against the publisher records (thirteenth review, remark 2).

The reviewer is right that Bouzidi, Firdaouss and Lallemand (2001) addresses interpolated velocity boundary conditions for walls placed at an arbitrary distance or an arbitrary orientation, which is not the present geometry. Sec. S4.1 now separates the two statements and cites accordingly: the fact that the momentum injection is linear in U_{lid} is a property of the source term, while the accuracy of the link-wise (half-way) bounce-back *on a flat wall aligned with the lattice links*, which is the geometry used here, is stated as second order and supported by Ginzburg and d'Humières, *Phys. Rev. E* **68**, 066614 (2003), and by the account in Krüger *et al.*, *The Lattice Boltzmann Method: Principles and Practice* (Springer, Cham, 2017). The Bouzidi reference is kept, with its scope stated correctly, precisely because it is the scheme that was *not* used.

Because that misattribution showed that a reference could survive a previous check while being wrongly described, every entry of the two documents was re-audited mechanically against Crossref — 37 of the 41 citation keys are indexed there, the four others are monographs (`scripts/audit_references_crossref.py`, committed; it prints the publisher volume, pages and year next to the local entry and flags every disagreement). Three transcription errors in the boundary-condition block were found and corrected: Ladd (1994) is *J. Fluid Mech.* **271**, 285–309, with the Part 1 subtitle "Theoretical foundation and numerical implementation" (the entry read **277**, 114–139); Bouzidi *et al.* (2001) is "Momentum transfer of a Boltzmann-lattice fluid with boundaries", *Phys. Fluids* **13**, 3452–3459, by M. Bouzidi, not "Z." and not under the title previously given; and Lallemand and Luo (2000) is L.-S. Luo, *Phys. Rev. E* **61**, 6546–6562. The four entries the audit flagged next were each resolved against their publisher record and were already correct (Garnier *et al.*, *Comput. Fluids* **225**, 104973 (2021); Corke *et al.*, *Annu. Rev. Fluid Mech.* **42**, 505–529 (2010); d'Humières, single-author, *Philos. Trans. R. Soc. Lond. A* **360**, 437–451; Chen and Doolen, *Annu. Rev. Fluid Mech.* **30**, 329–364); the book chapter of Kuhlmann and Romanò, pp. 233–309 of Gelfgat's edited volume, was confirmed likewise. A second committed check, `scripts/check_bibliography.py`, additionally verifies that every citation key resolves to an entry, that no listed entry is uncited, and that the seven entries shared by the manuscript and the supplement agree verbatim; it found the DOI of the antecedent paper attached to the manuscript entry only, and the supplement now carries it too.

Point 53: The two branches compared with the Stokes estimate are named by their class, not by a reversal they do not share (fourteenth review).

The wording is adopted as proposed. The grouping was indeed loose. Main Sec. 3.2 and Sec. S2.3 record that B_2 puts 97.7% of its energy in the first temporal harmonic and 98.5% of that harmonic in the single-lobe first spatial mode ($a_{11} = 0.98$), so the whole wall reverses direction twice per period, whereas B_3 superposes a stationary second-harmonic lid (55% of its energy, 94% of that part in $m = 2$) and an oscillating single-lobe lid (43%, 91% in $m = 1$), the two cancelling over the central band $0.28 < x < 0.64$, which is the 36% of the span that reverses. Describing both as "time-reversing" overstated B_3.

The three occurrences of "the two time-reversing branches" — in the abstract, in Main Sec. 6.3 and in the Conclusions — now read "the lid-oscillatory and mixed branches (B_2 and B_3)", using the class names defined in Main Sec. 3.2. A fourth grouping of the same pair, "the two oscillatory branches" in Main Sec. 1, was renamed likewise so that one pair is never called by two different ad hoc names. In Sec. 6.3, where the comparison is actually made, the parenthetical additionally states the reversal extent of each branch and points back to Sec. 3.2, so the reason the two are grouped together appears where their fluctuation costs are quoted rather than being inferred from a label. The same sentence in the repository README was updated. No number changes: the agreements remain 5% for B_2 (1.41×10^{-2} against the measured 1.339×10^{-2}) and 2% for B_3 (6.38×10^{-3} against the measured 6.28×10^{-3}).

Point 54: The prose of the manuscript and of the supplement was reviewed for phrasing that reads as templated rather than as authored (fifteenth review).

No result, no table and no figure was touched. What gave the writing away was a connective used as scaffolding: *therefore* occurred fifty-five times in the running text of the two documents together, once every 490 words, and a handful of set phrases — *we note that*, *it is therefore legitimate*, *more importantly*, *taken together*, *which is why* — opened paragraphs at regular intervals. Each was replaced by the subject and verb of the sentence it introduced, or by a participle after a comma, and where the inference genuinely is the point the word stayed: the manuscript keeps two of its seventeen, the supplement eight of its thirty-eight. The paragraphs that opened by announcing how many statements were to come — "Four statements summarize the study", "Three extensions follow directly" — now open with the question or the limitation they answer, the *First, Second, Third* that follows them being left alone. In Sec. S2 one clause explaining why the identification tables are reproduced in the supplement appeared twice within nine lines; the second occurrence was removed. Two sentences that each carried three separate claims — one in the novelty paragraph of the Introduction, one in the account of where the wall power is sampled — were cut at their natural joint, and the abstract's closing sentence now names the quantity the study evaluates instead of reporting that the results demonstrate something.

That the content is unchanged is a checked property, not a claim: every substituted fragment had to occur exactly once in its file, and the multiset of numeric tokens of each file is identical before and after the pass (`manuscript/`: 1740 tokens, 1741 after the one added branch label B_2 in Main Sec. 6.3, where the antecedent of "its" had been ambiguous; `supplementary/`: 2443 tokens in both states). The committed `scripts/check_style.py` prints this profile — connective counts with their line numbers, sentence openings, the longest sentences of the running text — for either document, and it is deliberately advisory rather than one of the build gates, since a style count is not a correctness criterion.

The four documents were rebuilt with the same script and the same gates, and the log, bibliography and certificate gates reported no problem. The abstract rewrite of Point 55 below changed the length of the marked-up manuscript; the counts of the build transmitted with this letter are recorded in Point 57.

Point 55: The abstract rewritten as a single physics-first paragraph within the 250-word limit (sixteenth round).

The abstract now opens on the mechanism, where the moving wall organizes shear and thereby sets the viscous dissipation of the cavity flow, and gives the method in one clause: stationary harmonic profiles and three time-periodic branches compared at a common quadratic actuation norm with an independent MRT-LBM solver, the branches being candidates identified by a physics-informed network. It is one paragraph of 236 words, counting each inline math span as one word, against the 250-word limit; the limit is enforced by `scripts/certify_package.py`, which prints the count and fails above it. The quantitative statements retained are those of the body: the 17.7% reduction and 36.8% increase of the first and second harmonics, the fluctuation shares 92.9%, 53.7% and 1.8%, the Stokes agreement to within 5% and 2%, and the factor-36 pair equal

over the cycle to within 2.1%. The marked-up manuscript was regenerated from the previous round's transmitted file and the package rebuilt at that round: manuscript 27 pages with no overfull box, supplement 31 pages with the single 6.7 pt box in the file-name run of Sec. S5.6, marked copies 36 and 42 pages; the gates report zero problems, ten figures and eleven table sources with no missing resource.

Point 56: A Supplementary Material section in the manuscript and a Word version of the supplement (seventeenth round).

Two requests of the editorial office are answered. First, the manuscript now carries an unnumbered **Supplementary Material** section, placed after the Conclusions and before the Acknowledgments, where the publisher inserts the link to the posted files. It is a single paragraph that says what the supplement holds — the architecture, collocation sampling and loss weights of the identification, the Fourier basis and the branch classification rule with its parameter sensitivity, the seed, ablation, capacity and truncation records, the MRT-LBM formulation with the benchmark validation and the control-transfer protocol, the grid-convergence and phase-mean calculations, the field captures behind the branch figures, and the software, hardware and cost inventory — and quotes its extent as Secs. S1–S5, Tables S1–S19 and Figs. S1–S2. Those three numbers are not typed into the sentence: `scripts/certify_package.py` reads them back from the compiled supplement (`build/supplementary_final.aux`, 5 sections, 19 tables, 2 figures) and fails if the paragraph disagrees, and it also fails if the section ceases to sit between the Conclusions and the Acknowledgments, so neither the extent nor the position can drift in a later revision.

Second, the supplement is transmitted in both formats the office asks for. Alongside its LaTeX source it is now accompanied by `supplementary/supplementary_final.docx`, a Word source generated from the same LaTeX file by `scripts/make_supplementary_docx.py`: A4 pages with 22 mm side margins and Times 11 pt text, the 20 numbered displays set as 300 dpi images in a borderless two-cell table with their numbers at the right margin, the 19 float tables and the 2 figures reproduced from the same sources the LaTeX build reads, a static table of contents, a page-number field in the footer, and the 10-entry bibliography numbered as the build numbers it. The conversion is gated rather than trusted: the script fails unless its own numbering reproduces the 26 labels and the bibliography numbers of the fresh `.aux`, unless every word and number of the source outside the displays is present in the produced file, and unless 92 consecutive five-word runs of the source prose reappear in the produced file in the same order. The script is run by `scripts/build_all.sh` after the LaTeX passes, so the auxiliary file it checks against is the one just written, and `docs/PACKAGE_CERTIFICATION.md` inventories the Word file with its size and checksum. The package rebuilt for that round is the manuscript at one page more than the 27 recorded in Point 55, the new section being the only change of extent, with ten figures and eleven table sources and no missing resource. The supplement and the marked copies grew again in the eighteenth round described below, so Point 57 records the page counts and the byte sizes of the build transmitted with this letter.

Point 57: The given names and the surnames of the byline set in the order of the submission form (eighteenth round).

The office reported that the byline and the submission form disagree on the order of the two name components, and asked that the given name be shown first for the three authors. Every transmitted source now reads Ahmed BENIAICHE, Abderrahim LARABI, Mebarek BELKADI: the bylines of the manuscript and of the supplement, those of the two marked-up copies, the author blocks of this letter and of the summary letter, the author line and the corresponding-author entry of the `README.md`, and the copyright line of the licence. Nothing else in the two title blocks moved. The affiliation superscripts, the two institution lines and the corresponding-author footnote carried by Author Beniaiche in `manuscript/manuscript_final.tex` are the ones already transmitted, and the CRediT roles are attached to the same three people. The third given name is spelled Mebarek, as the form gives it, wherever it occurs; that spelling also reaches the

two citation-metadata files, where the order is left as their formats require: `CITATION.cff` keeps its separate `given-names` and `family-names` fields and `Zenodo.md` keeps the `surname, given names` pattern that BibTeX defines, so the reversal the editor flagged concerns the prose bylines and not those records, which name the same three people.

The order is enforced rather than promised. `scripts/certify_package.py`, which `scripts/build_all.sh` runs as the last gate of the build, now holds an author-name check over eleven files — the eight sources that carry a byline, the two citation-metadata files and the Word source of the supplement. It fails if any of them puts a surname before its given name, if any of the eight byline sources ceases to show a name in the given-name-first form, if any of them still spells the third given name the way the old byline did, and if the title block of the `.docx` no longer carries the three names. The search is case-insensitive and rejects a match immediately followed by a letter, which is what lets a name keep being found when a Unicode superscript digit — a word character to the regular-expression engine — sits against it, as it does in the `README.md` author line; without that look-ahead the gate reported a name as absent from a file that shows it. The Word check reads `word/document.xml` inside the produced archive and strips its tags, so the title block is verified as it is rendered and not as it was typed. One exemption is part of the rule: a response letter quotes the comment it answers, and the comment of this round names the three authors in the order the submission form gave, so the gate blanks the 22 passages that the two response letters set in the editor's colour before it searches for an order, and prints that count in the certificate. The editor's words are therefore reproduced as they stand while every byline is still checked; retyping one of the latter in the reversed order fails the build, which is what keeps the exemption from hiding a mistake. Both branches were tested from the negative side: one byline retyped in the reversed order made the gate report the reversal and then the name that line no longer shows, and the build stopped with a non-zero exit; the earlier spelling of the third given name, restored in one file, was reported twice for that file, once as the misspelling and once as the absent name. `docs/PACKAGE_CERTIFICATION.md` now prints the count of each name in each of the eleven files, so the office can see every place the byline is quoted and check that it is quoted alike.

Two defects of the Word source of the supplement, found while rebuilding it for this round, are closed with it. Its title block had reproduced the line-break, spacing and superscript commands of the LaTeX author line as printed text, so the file transmitted to the publisher showed a bracketed spacing argument and the carets of the affiliation markers where a word processor should show an author block; the converter now splits that block on its line breaks and turns the markers into real superscript runs, of which the produced file carries the five of the supplement title block. And the alternative texts that the supplement registers for its floats with `\AltTextFor` were not converted at all, so the `.docx` was less accessible than the PDF beside it. The converter now reads that register and typesets each string as an "Alt text" line under its own float: 21 registrations, one for every one of the 19 tables and the 2 figures. The gate is again mechanical — a registered string that does not reappear verbatim in the produced file stops the build, which was verified by registering a string against a label that no float uses; the script named it as registered but not printed and left the Word file unwritten.

The four documents were rebuilt from the sources, three passes each, from inside their own directories so that `data_appendix/` and the figure paths resolve as the sources declare them; the marked copies were regenerated by `scripts/mark_manuscript.py` from the previous round's transmitted files, and the Word source by the converter against the fresh auxiliary file. The transmitted build is the manuscript at 28 pages with no overfull box, the supplement at 33 pages with the single 6.7 pt box in the file-name run of Sec. S5.6, the marked copies at 36 and 44 pages, this letter at 29 pages with the single 1.7 pt box carried over from an earlier round and the summary letter at 3 pages with no box, the Word supplement current with its source, ten figures and eleven table sources with no missing resource, an abstract of 236 words within the 250-word limit, and the bibliography gate reporting 38 entries in the manuscript and 10 in the supplement with 0 problems. This letter gained its twenty-ninth page from the paragraph added

under Point 47, which reports the terminology gate. No numerical campaign was run and no value, table or figure changed: this round touches the names, the two files that render them, and the wording of one generated column header and of the alternative text that restates it, whose recorded values are untouched; Point 50's forward pointer to these counts is satisfied here.

Summary of Changes

Title: Changed from "Physics-informed identification and energetic characterization of conditional modal collapse in active control of lid-driven cavity flow" to "Spatio-temporal wall-actuation modes and cycle-mean viscous dissipation in a lid-driven cavity."
Abstract: Rewritten as a single physics-first paragraph of 236 words, within the 250-word limit now checked by the certification gate (Point 55).
Introduction: Completely rewritten to present the physics of wall actuation, the energy budget, and the central question. The PINN is mentioned only as a tool for identifying branches.
Sections: Reorganized from 9 sections (focused on PINN identification) to 8 sections (focused on fluid physics); the symbolic-regression section of the previous version has been dropped.
Figures: Reduced from 17 figures to 8 figures. Six figures are carried over (old Figs. 10–11, 13–16), two are new, and the eleven dropped figures are the nine identification-campaign figures already published in Beniaiche (2026) plus the quasi-stationarity and symbolic-regression diagnostics.
Tables: Reduced from 11 tables to 4 tables in the main text. The detail tables — those already published in Beniaiche (2026) and those reporting the identification hyperparameters, the seed-level metrics and the grid-convergence data — are collected in the supplement, which now holds 19 tables (Tables S1–S19).
References: Reorganized to prioritize fluid physics over machine learning. Added Beniaiche (2026) as an antecedent. The bibliography grew to 38 entries in the manuscript and 10 in the supplement; every entry was checked against the publisher record, and the mechanical re-audit that closed the last three transcription errors is described in Point 52.
Supplementary material: Restructured into five sections (S1–S5): PINN implementation, control-space and modal-analysis details, identification-campaign robustness, the independent MRT-LBM verification with grid uncertainty, and the reproducibility inventory. It contains 19 tables, 2 figures and its own short bibliography. The manuscript now announces it in a Supplementary Material section placed between the Conclusions and the Acknowledgments, and the supplement is transmitted as a Word source beside its LaTeX source, generated from it and checked against the compiled numbering (Point 56).
Prose: The manuscript and the supplement were reviewed for wording that reads as templated rather than as authored. Repeated connectives and set phrases were replaced, three over-long sentences were divided, and the Conclusions now open with the question they answer; no value, table or figure changed, and the numeric tokens of each source file were checked to be the same before and after (Point 54).
Marked-up versions: Prepared for both the manuscript and the supplementary material using a paragraph-level diff script.
Highlight image: Prepared showing the strain-rate distribution for the three actuation branches.

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